SINCE 2016
MINDRAIN
WORKSHOPS

FUNCTION FOLLOWS FORM

2026-2027

ARCHITECTURAL DESIGN WORKSHOP

#EDITION 02

Think beyond the box.
Design with intent.

DURATION
3 days online + 6 days offline

OFFLINE WORKSHOP DATES
17–23 December 2026

LOCATION
Hyderabad, Telangana, India

#WORKSHOP BRIEF



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A guide to the workshop, learning experience, deliverables, and participant arrangements.

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01 About the Workshop

Function Follows Form is a nine-day, hands-on architectural design workshop designed to introduce students to the fundamentals of architectural design and encourage them to move beyond conventional, box-like approaches to architecture.

Through guided sessions, practical exercises and form exploration, participants will discover how concepts evolve into forms, how spaces respond to human needs, and how design decisions can be developed and communicated with clarity.

Workshop Capacity: The workshop has a limited capacity of 15 participants.

02 What Will You Learn?

- **Fundamentals of Design:** Understanding design principles, design problems, and the architectural design process.
- **Concept Development:** Translating ideas, observations, and inspirations into meaningful design concepts.
- **Form Exploration:** Experimenting with geometry, massing, volumes, and spatial compositions beyond conventional forms.
- **Space and Function:** Exploring spatial relationships, circulation, zoning, and the interaction between form and function.
- **Creative Design Thinking:** Questioning assumptions, exploring alternatives, and approaching design problems with originality.
- **Design Communication:** Presenting design decisions, explaining design intent, and responding to critical feedback.

03 The Workshop Experience

The program will combine guided learning sessions, hands-on design exercises, model-making and form exploration with an emphasis on one-to-one design discussions.

Online Sessions: Three days of online classes will be conducted before the in-person workshop begins.

Program Timeline:
Online classes: 12–14 December 2026
Hotel check-in (Day 0): 16 December 2026
Offline workshop (Days 1–6): 17–22 December 2026
Check-out (Day 7): 23 December 2026 by 10:00 AM.

The students will be required to have special readings, suggested by the experts, to help them expand their understanding of architecture and design.

The focus will be on experimentation, critical thinking, and learning by doing—not on finding one predetermined correct answer.

04 Final Deliverables

By the end of the workshop, participants will work towards completing:

- **Final Design Proposal:** A conceptual architectural design demonstrating the principles explored during the workshop.
- **Physical Study Model:** A three-dimensional representation of the proposed form and spatial ideas.
- **Jury-Style Presentation:** A presentation explaining the design concept, development process, spatial decisions, and final proposal.

The final exercise will be scoped to suit the six-day program, allowing participants to experience the journey from an initial idea to a presented architectural concept.

Certificates

On the final jury day, the jury will select the three best designs. **"BEST DESIGN CERTIFICATE"** will be awarded for the three selected designs. All other participants will receive a **"Completion Certificate"** for completing the workshop.

05 Registration Process

1. **Online Application:** Interested participants **must submit answers to the questions and LOR (letter of recommendation) by one Design faculty who has thought them Architectural Design,** in the registration form available on the MindRain website.
2. **Shortlisting:** Applicants selected from the submitted forms will be nominated for a video interview with the workshop expert.
3. **Final Selection:** MindRain will get in touch with the selected participants to inform them of their selection and share the next steps.
4. **Fee Payment:** Selected participants will be required to pay the registration fee to confirm their participation in the workshop. Payment instructions will be provided by the MindRain team.

06 Who Can Participate?

The workshop is primarily intended for first- and second-year architecture students who want to strengthen their design fundamentals, develop confidence in their ideas, and explore alternatives to conventional studio approaches. However, any architecture student can attend the workshop if they wish to.

No advanced design expertise is required. Curiosity, willingness to experiment, and active participation are encouraged. Even the students who don't have any prior experience or knowledge of architecture can also join if they are interested. This workshop will start everything from the very basics.

07 Accommodation

Accommodation will be provided in hotels rated 3-star or above, subject to the final arrangements.

- **Check-in: 16 December 2026 (Day 0), one day before the offline workshop begins.**
- **Offline workshop dates: 17–22 December 2026 (Days 1–6).**
- **Check-out: 23 December 2026 (Day 7), by 10:00 AM.**
- **Room sharing:** Two or three participants per room (depending on availability and size of room).
- **Accommodation details, including the hotel location, will be shared individually with each participant no later than five days before the offline workshop begins.**

Participants must vacate their rooms by 10:00 AM on Day 7. Any extension of stay beyond the provided accommodation period must be arranged and paid for by the participant, subject to hotel availability.

08 Meals and Refreshments

Meals and refreshments will be provided from Day 1 through Day 7 (17–23 December 2026), including:

- **Breakfast**
- **Lunch**
- **Evening snacks**

Meal policy: All included meals will be vegetarian. Non-vegetarian meals may be available at an additional cost, depending on the hotel's services and availability. Any additional charges must be borne by the participant.

Dinner arrangements: Dinner is not included in the workshop provisions. Participants may order dinner from the restaurant available at the accommodation, subject to its operating hours and menu, or order from other restaurants independently at their own expense.

09 Stationery and Model-Making Materials

All stationery and materials required for the planned design exercises and physical model-making activities during the offline mode of the workshop will be provided by Mind Rain.

10 Expected Learning Outcomes

By the end of the nine-day workshop, participants are expected to develop:

- **A foundational understanding** of architectural design principles.
- **A structured approach** to concept generation and design development.
- **Greater confidence** in exploring unconventional forms and spatial ideas.
- **An understanding** of the relationship between form, function, and spatial experience.
- **Practical experience** in model-making and design representation.
- **Communication skills** to articulate, present, and defend design decisions.

11 Registration Fees

The registration fee for the **Function Follows Form** Architectural Design Workshop is **₹15,999 per participant** for Indian participants and **$330** for international participants, including all taxes and fees.

12 The Objective

Function Follows Form aims to challenge the habit of designing by default. It encourages students to question familiar solutions, explore possibilities, and understand the reasoning behind their architectural decisions.

THINK BEYOND THE BOX. DESIGN WITH INTENT.